To the Easterner, there is no law greater than the law of continuity, wherein opposites are merely differences of degree and not differences of quality. There are no strict dichotomies, especially in the mind of an Indian. Even materialism is not exclusively banished from the spiritual field. God is alternatively what the individual sees in Him. The Divine also has infinite levels. The Eastern man gives a picture of syncretism in his make-up, in all kinds of situations and in doctrine, thought, and practice. If you ask me whether I am a Hindu or Christian, I find it difficult to reply. I am a Hindu because I was born in that particular family.

As a result, the man in the West produces a picture of more strife and stress, pressure, and strain than does the man in the East. This is not to say that the man in the West is merely more industrious and hardworking but to say that, in addition, he is, in some undesirable sense, more than merely hardworking. This need not be. Western man presents a different picture when he is relaxed than when he is at work. The end-all and the be-all of his life is success, no matter where. On the contrary, the man in the East presents a picture of following some ideal unmindful of success or failure and this is one reason why he does not need as much relaxation as his counterpart in the West, because in a deeper sense, he is always relaxed even in the midst of work.

We have to admit that the individual in the East or in the West is not perfect, and it would be just as foolish or unfair to condemn either one. There are obvious difficulties in the evaluation of either the Eastern or the Western man, but we need not go into these difficulties here, except to admit that the present task cannot free us from doubt and has no claim to any finality. There is a tendency in all of us, Eastern or Western, to regard ourselves and the group we belong to as superior to any other. Asia or the East is also changing, and the distinctions drawn between the Easterner and the Westerner will have to be re-evaluated in the course of time. There may soon come an age of industrialization in the East with attendant changes in the familial and social relationships. Many of the features that differentiate traditional Asia from the West may no longer remain uniquely Asian. Eventually, we will have to drop the terms Orient and Occident, except to indicate geographical locations.

It appears that an Easterner differs from his Western counterpart in the concept of the family. To a Westerner, his family means only his wife and children. That is to say, he understands family as a two-generation concept, himself and his children, occasionally perhaps including a third generation, his parents. Family in the